



| NIGERIA PEOPLES AND CULTURE



CITIZENSHIP AND CIVIC RESPONSIBILITIES

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Define and explain the concept of citizenship.
- Explain the basic elements and attributes of being a citizen.
- Identify and describe specific civic responsibilities and duties.





WHAT IS CITIZENSHIP ?

Citizenship is described as the state of being a citizen, as well as the rights, obligations, and advantages that come with it.

You have the right to live, work, vote, and pay taxes in a nation if you have citizenship there.

Citizenship entails more than just leaving somewhere. Citizenship is usually granted in the nation where you were born. However, if you are an immigrant from another nation, you must apply.





HISTORY OF CITIZENSHIP IN NIGERIA

Citizenship is often confused with nationality, which is of a wider scope than citizenship. The Nigerian Constitution from the time of independence provides for some types of citizenship, but before the date of independence there were no Nigerian citizens.

Since 1979, there have been significant changes in the law relating to citizenship in Nigeria, such as the enactment of the Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria in 1979, the Nigeria Citizenship Act 1960, and the Nigerian Citizenship Act 1961.





CONSTITUTIONAL PROVISION OF CITIZENSHIP IN NIGERIA.

Every country has the right to decide who will be its citizen. Chapter three of the Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria 1999 (as amended) provides extensively for citizenship in Nigeria.

A person can be a Nigerian citizen by one of the following ways:

- By birth
- By registration
- By naturalisation.



Citizenship by birth



Citizenship by naturalisation



Citizenship by registration



CITIZENSHIP BY BIRTH

Citizenship by birth, according to the 1999 constitution, means that a person is a Nigerian citizen by birth if:

- I. Both parents are Nigerians
- II. Either parents is a Nigerian
- III. Any or one of the grandparents is a Nigerian





CITIZENSHIP BY REGISTRATION

Citizenship of Nigeria by registration is open to:

1. A non-Nigerian woman who is married to a Nigerian; and
2. Every person of full age and capacity born outside Nigeria, whose grandparent is a citizen of Nigeria.





CITIZENSHIP BY REGISTRATION

To qualify as a foreigner, he/she must prove to the President that:

- I. He/she is a person of good character;
- II. He/she has shown a clear intention of his desire to be domiciled or to live, or reside in Nigeria; and
- III. He/she has taken the prescribed Oath of Allegiance to Nigeria contained in the Seventh Schedule to the 1999 Constitution.



CITIZENSHIP BY NATURALISATION

Naturalisation is the process by which an individual becomes a legal citizen of a specific country. It refers to the formal act of granting citizenship to a foreign national who meets the predetermined eligibility criteria established by the country's laws and regulations.

In this sense, one can become a legal citizen of Nigeria by fulfilling the requirements as stipulated in section 27 of the 1999 Constitution. After this, a certificate of grant of citizenship by naturalisation is issued to the person. This is the means by which any foreigner who has lived for a long time in Nigeria may become a Nigerian citizen.





DUAL CITIZENSHIP

The Nigeria Constitution allows dual citizenship for a foreigner who is a citizen of another country by birth to also be a citizen of Nigeria, by registration or by naturalization. A citizen by birth can also acquire the citizenship of another country without renouncing his Nigerian citizenship.





RENUNCIATION OF CITIZENSHIP

A citizen of Nigeria who is of full age has the right to renounce and abandon his Nigerian citizenship and take up the citizenship of any other country of his choice, by making the prescribed declaration to that effect.

However, the President of Nigeria also has a right to refuse the registration of such declaration, renouncing the citizenship, especially where such declaration was made;

1. when Nigeria is involved in a war; or
2. contrary to public policy.



LOSS OF CITIZENSHIP

The President of Nigeria may deprive a person who is not a Nigerian by birth, or by registration, of Nigerian citizenship in the following circumstances:

1. If the person is sentenced to a term of imprisonment not less than 3 years within a period of 7 years after becoming a citizen of Nigeria by naturalisation.





LOSS OF CITIZENSHIP

2. Persons who acquired Nigerian citizenship by naturalisation or by registration may lose Nigeria citizenship if:

- A. If the person is disloyal to Nigeria by act or speech;
- B. if the person traded with, engaged, or associated with any business with an enemy country at war with Nigeria;
- C. Assisted the enemy country at war with Nigeria in any manner;
- D. Unlawfully communicated with such enemy country to the detriment of, or with the intention to cause damage to Nigeria.



MID-LESSON ACTIVITY

Under what circumstances can the President of Nigeria refuse the registration of a declaration to renounce Nigerian citizenship?

- A) When Nigeria is involved in a war.
- B) When the citizen wants to move to a neighboring African country.
- C) When the citizen wants to pursue higher education abroad.
- D) When the citizen reaches a certain age.



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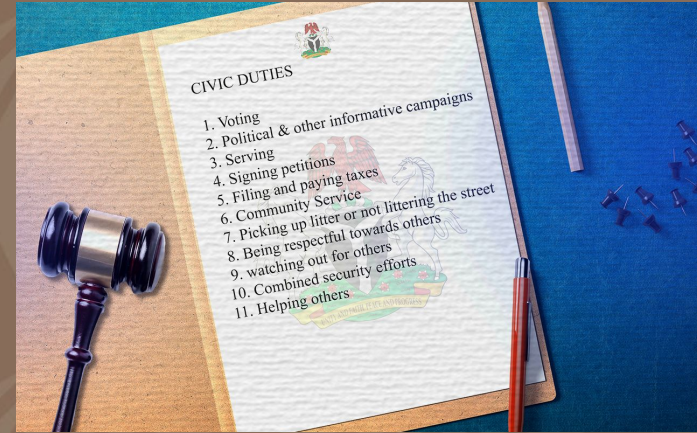
The President of Nigeria has the right to refuse the registration of a declaration to renounce Nigerian citizenship when Nigeria is involved in a war or when the declaration is contrary to public policy. This means that during times of war, the President can deny such requests for the sake of national security or other important reasons.



CIVIC RESPONSIBILITY

Civic responsibility refers to the duties and obligations that citizens are expected to fulfill for the betterment of their society and the functioning of their country. These responsibilities are outlined in various laws, policies, and cultural expectations. They are:

1. Obey the law
2. Protection of Public Property
3. Payment of Taxes
4. Rendering National Service
5. Loyalty
6. Respect for others rights





CIVIC RESPONSIBILITY (CONTD.)

These are contained in Section 24 of The Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria 1999 (as amended). It provides as follows:
It shall be the duty of every citizen to -

- A. Abide by this Constitution, respect its ideals and its institutions, the National Flag, the National Anthem, the National Pledge, and legitimate authorities;
- B. Help to enhance the power, prestige and good name of Nigeria, defend Nigeria and render such national service as may be required;





CIVIC RESPONSIBILITY (CONTD.)

- C. Respect the dignity of other citizens and the rights and legitimate interests of others and live in unity and harmony and in the spirit of common brotherhood;
- D. Make positive and useful contribution to the advancement, progress and well-being of the community where he resides;
- E. Render assistance to appropriate and lawful agencies in the maintenance of law and order; and
- F. Declare his income honestly to appropriate and lawful agencies and pay his tax promptly.





CONCLUSION

It is important to note that civic responsibility is not only a legal obligation but also a moral duty that promotes active citizenship and contributes to the overall development of Nigeria. By fulfilling these responsibilities, citizens can actively contribute to a thriving and inclusive society.





SUMMARY

- Citizenship is described as the state of being a citizen, as well as the rights, obligations, and advantages that come with it.
- Civic responsibility refers to the duties and obligations that citizens are expected to fulfill for the betterment of their society and the functioning of their country.





REFERENCES/FURTHER READING

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